

PRANAVA

Center for Indian Culture & Yogic Studies

Website Design & Development Blueprint

Version 1.0 • Neutral / Platform-Agnostic Requirement Document

Document Purpose

This document defines what the Pranava website should communicate, contain, feel like and enable. It deliberately does not prescribe a WordPress theme, Elementor kit, visual template, hosting provider, page builder or specific development stack. A competent designer/developer should be able to use this document as the primary brief for proposing and building the website.

This is a Version 1 foundation: enough to get Pranava operational online without allowing future ambitions—such as a full LMS, student portal, digital library or complex institutional CMS—to delay the first launch.

1. Executive Brief

1.1 The website in one sentence

The Pranava website should feel like the digital entrance to a contemporary Gurukula: an authentic, calm and scholarly institution where Yoga and allied Indian knowledge traditions are studied, practised, taught and applied with integrity.

1.2 What the website must achieve

- Introduce Pranava as an institution rather than merely a yoga service provider.
- Help visitors distinguish structured learning, ongoing practice and health-support offerings.
- Present current programs clearly and make it easy to enquire or apply.
- Establish credibility through faculty, methodology, experience, student experiences and useful educational content.
- Provide a maintainable foundation that the Pranava team can update without depending on a developer for every small change.
- Allow the website to grow later without requiring the entire site to be rebuilt.

1.3 What it should not become

- A generic yoga-studio website.
- A fitness or gym website.
- A spa or luxury wellness website.
- A sales-heavy certification marketplace.
- A cluttered portal containing every future idea from day one.
- A website whose identity is visibly dictated by a purchased template.

2. Institutional Positioning

2.1 Organisation

Pranava – Center for Indian Culture & Yogic Studies

2.2 Core positioning

Pranava is an educational and practice-oriented institution rooted in Yoga and the wider Indian knowledge traditions. It combines traditional study and practice with responsible contemporary understanding.

2.3 Brand personality

- Authentic
- Scholarly
- Traditional but not archaic
- Calm
- Grounded
- Welcoming
- Precise
- Non-sensational
- Institutional rather than commercial

2.4 Brand experience

A visitor should feel that they have entered a place of study and practice. The website should invite curiosity and trust rather than create urgency.

3. Primary Visitor Journeys

The information architecture should be organised around what visitors are trying to do, rather than around internal organisational departments.

Journey	Visitor intent	Indicative content
Learn	I want structured education	Teacher education, courses, intensives, workshops and foundational/advanced study
Practice	I want consistent Sādhana	Regular practice programs, Prāṇāyāma, retreats and ongoing practice
Heal	I want health-oriented guidance	Pranava Svasthya, Yoga Therapy, Ayurveda, Nutrition and Women's Wellness
Insights	I want to understand more	Articles, journal, resources, FAQs and educational material

4. Information Architecture

4.1 Primary navigation

Recommended V1 navigation:

About | Learn | Practice | Heal | Insights | Events | Contact

A restrained Apply / Enquire action may appear as a header action. Keep the navigation simple in V1 and avoid deep multi-level menus.

4.2 Core pages

- Home
- About
- Learn
- Practice

- Heal
- Insights
- Events
- Contact - Apply / Enquire

4.3 Program pages

Individual programs should have dedicated pages using a consistent structure. Current examples may include Pravesha, Pragraha, Prayatna, Praguna, Prabodha, Prāṇāyāma-related programs and future offerings.

4.4 Future scalability

The chosen implementation should make it possible later to introduce structured program records, faculty records, events, resources and other content types without forcing a complete redesign.

5. Homepage Requirements

The homepage should answer three questions quickly: What is Pranava? What can I explore here? What should I do next?

Section	Requirement
01 — Hero	Clear institutional headline; concise positioning statement; primary CTA to Explore Learning; secondary CTA to Meet Pranava or equivalent; one strong authentic image. No automatic slider.
02 — Welcome to Pranava	Short institutional introduction explaining the educational and practice orientation.
03 — Choose Your Journey	Four pathways: Learn, Practice, Heal, Insights.
04 — Featured Programs	3–4 current or flagship programs, not every offering.
05 — Why Pranava	Methodology, teaching integrity, faculty experience, individual guidance, continuity of practice and integrated approach.
06 — Founder / Faculty	Introduce the people behind the institution without making the organisation appear to be a personal-brand website.
07 — Student Experiences	Genuine testimonials; avoid exaggerated claims.
08 — Upcoming Programs & Events	Current opportunities with date, mode/location and clear action.
09 — Insights	Latest educational articles/resources.
10 — Community / Continue Your Journey	Invitation to stay connected without aggressive lead generation.
11 — Footer	Institutional navigation, contact, social channels and legal links.

6. Page Specifications

About

Institutional story → Vision/Mission → Teaching philosophy → Values → Founder → Faculty → approach → CTA.

Learn

Explain structured learning → program categories → featured/current programs → how to choose → FAQs → enquiry.

Practice

Explain ongoing Sādhana → regular practice → Prayatna and related offerings → Prāṇāyāma → retreats/immersions → schedule/enquiry.

Heal

Introduce Pranava Svasthya → Yoga Therapy → Ayurveda → Nutrition → Women's Wellness → responsible consultation CTA.

Insights

Featured article → categories → latest articles → search → resources/downloads → subscription/community invitation.

Events

Upcoming events → event details → registration/enquiry → past events later.

Contact

Contact routes → enquiry form → location/mode information → social links → FAQs.

7. Individual Program Page Specification

1. Hero: Program name, short positioning statement and primary CTA.
2. Why this program exists.
3. Who it is for / suitability.
4. Prerequisites, if any.
5. Curriculum / what is covered.
6. Learning outcomes.
7. Format: duration, schedule, location/mode and session structure.
8. Fee and inclusions.
9. Faculty.
10. Student experiences/testimonials.
11. FAQs.
12. Related articles/resources.
13. Final enquiry/application CTA.

Build this as a reusable content pattern so future programs do not require designing every page from scratch.

8. Visual Design Direction

8.1 Desired aesthetic

Traditional, editorial, warm, spacious, understated and scholarly. The visual language may draw subtle inspiration from the Gurukula, Indian manuscript traditions, natural materials, quiet architecture and the visual calm of a serious educational institution.

8.2 Colour direction

Role	Colour	HEX
Primary	Deep Forest Green	#264B3C
Background	Handmade Paper	#F8F5EF
Secondary	Warm Sandstone	#D8C6A5
Accent	Antique Brass	#B08D57
Text	Dark Charcoal	#2D2D2D
Optional Accent	Muted Maroon	#6E3B3B

8.3 Typography direction

Preferred starting system: Cormorant Garamond for major display headings; Inter for body/UI/navigation; Noto Serif Devanagari for Sanskrit/Devanagari content. The designer may propose alternatives if they preserve the intended character and readability.

8.4 Photography

- Prioritise real Pranava teaching and practice environments.
- Show learning, observation, correction, study, books, props, discussions and community.
- Use natural light and restrained composition.
- Avoid generic stock yoga imagery, extreme flexibility, fitness-gym imagery, luxury-spa imagery and cliché spiritual imagery.

9. UI / UX Requirements

- Clear hierarchy and generous whitespace.
- Responsive design for desktop, tablet and mobile.
- Consistent buttons, cards, typography, forms and spacing.
- Primary actions should be visually clear but never aggressive.
- Minimal animation; motion should support orientation, not decoration.
- Readable long-form content with comfortable line length.
- Accessible contrast and keyboard-friendly controls.
- Alt text and semantic heading hierarchy.
- Mobile navigation should be simple and shallow in V1.
- Do not use carousels/sliders unless there is a strong content reason.

10. Content & Tone

10.1 Voice

Knowledgeable, calm, respectful, clear, warm and non-preachy. The website should educate before it sells.

10.2 Preferred language

Avoid	Prefer
Buy Now	Explore the Program
Hurry / Last Chance	Applications Open / Enquire
Customer (education)	Student / Practitioner
Instructor	Teacher / Faculty
Transform your life instantly	Develop a guided, sustainable practice
Click Here	View Program Details

11. Technical & Functional Requirements

The developer may recommend the implementation stack. The following are requirements, not prescriptions.

- Content management must be manageable by non-developer team members after handover.
- Page templates/components should be reusable.
- Global design tokens/styles should be centrally controlled.
- Forms must be secure, spam-protected and deliver enquiries reliably.
- Site must support basic SEO controls, metadata, sitemap and structured content.
- Site must support analytics and search performance tools.
- Images should be optimised for performance.
- Site should support HTTPS, regular backups and basic security hardening.
- A staging/development environment should be used for major changes.
- Documentation or a short handover guide should be supplied to the Pranava team.
- Developer must clearly identify paid plugins/services and recurring costs.
- Pranava should retain ownership/control of the domain, hosting, CMS administrator account and relevant licences.

12. CMS / Content Management Requirements

The final system should allow the Pranava team to update, without developer intervention wherever reasonably possible:

- Program descriptions, fees and schedules
- Faculty profiles
- Events
- Articles/Insights
- Images
- FAQs
- Testimonials
- Contact information
- Homepage featured content

- Links and calls to action

Avoid hard-coding information that is likely to change.

13. Search Engine & Discoverability Basics

- Search-engine-friendly URLs.
- Editable page titles and meta descriptions.
- Logical heading hierarchy.
- XML sitemap.
- Indexing controls.
- Open Graph/social sharing metadata.
- Image alt text.
- Basic schema/structured data where appropriate.
- Google Search Console and analytics integration where available.
- Fast loading and mobile-friendly implementation.

14. Forms, Enquiries & Lead Handling

- General contact/enquiry form.
- Program-specific enquiry/application routing.
- Clear confirmation state.
- Email delivery verification.
- Spam protection.
- Privacy/consent checkbox where required.
- Optional WhatsApp/contact action.
- Future compatibility with CRM/email automation without requiring a rebuild.

15. Ownership & Handover Requirements

This is a critical requirement for any external developer.

- Domain must be registered in Pranava's ownership/control.
- Hosting account must remain under Pranava's control.
- Pranava must receive administrator-level CMS access.
- All third-party licences purchased for the project must be documented.
- No essential functionality should depend on a developer's private account.
- Developer must provide a list of installed plugins/services and their purpose.
- Developer must provide backup/restore instructions.
- Developer must provide basic content-editing instructions.
- All project-specific design/source assets should be handed over where contractually applicable.

16. Content Required Before Launch

- Final logo and logo variants.
- Institutional introduction.

- Founder biography and portrait.
- Faculty biographies and portraits.
- Current programs, descriptions, schedules and fees.
- Upcoming events.
- 3–6 genuine testimonials.
- Pranava photographs.
- Initial articles for Insights.
- Pranava Svasthya service descriptions.
- Contact details and preferred enquiry channels.
- Privacy policy and other applicable legal pages.

17. V1 Build Sequence

14. Discovery and requirement confirmation.
15. Information architecture and sitemap.
16. Wireframe/homepage layout approval.
17. Visual design system approval.
18. CMS/platform and implementation architecture.
19. Development environment/staging setup.
20. Global styles/components.
21. Header and footer.
22. Homepage.
23. About and Faculty.
24. Learn and reusable Program page.
25. Practice.
26. Heal / Pranava Svasthya landing page.
27. Insights and article template.
28. Events.
29. Contact and Apply/Enquire.
30. Content population.
31. Responsive optimisation.
32. SEO, analytics, security, backup and performance.
33. Testing and launch.

18. Definition of Done — V1

V1 is complete when a first-time visitor can understand Pranava, choose Learn / Practice / Heal / Insights, explore relevant programs, understand who teaches them, access useful educational content, and enquire/apply—with the same experience working well on desktop and mobile.

19. Launch Checklist

- ☐ Domain connected and HTTPS active
- ☐ Production/staging workflow established
- ☐ Navigation complete

- ☐ Homepage approved
- ☐ All core pages complete
- ☐ Program template tested with at least two programs
- ☐ Faculty profiles complete
- ☐ Forms tested end-to-end
- ☐ Mobile/tablet layouts checked
- ☐ Images optimised and alt text added
- ☐ SEO titles/meta descriptions reviewed
- ☐ Sitemap/indexing checked
- ☐ Analytics/Search Console configured
- ☐ Privacy/legal pages published
- ☐ Backup and security configured
- ☐ Broken links checked
- ☐ 404 page checked
- ☐ Social links checked
- ☐ All demo/template content removed
- ☐ Admin credentials and ownership documented
- ☐ Developer handover completed
- ☐ Final founder/stakeholder approval

20. Deliberately Deferred to V2+

- Full LMS and student dashboard.
- Online course delivery infrastructure.
- Digital library/resource repository.
- Advanced member/community portal.
- Complex CRM automation.
- Advanced program filtering and database architecture.
- Research/archive section.
- Large e-commerce system.
- Mobile app.
- Full separate Pranava Svasthya website.
- Custom institutional design system beyond what V1 requires.

21. Questions the Developer Should Answer Before Work Begins

- What platform/CMS do you recommend and why?
- What parts will Pranava be able to edit without a developer?
- What recurring costs will exist after launch?
- Which plugins/services are required and which are optional?
- How will staging and backups be handled?
- How will the website be secured and updated?
- How will forms and enquiries be delivered?
- How will SEO and analytics be configured?
- What is included in the handover?
- What happens if Pranava later changes the design or developer?
- Can the proposed architecture support future Pranava Svasthya expansion and a structured program library?

22. Developer Deliverables

- Responsive production website.
- Configured CMS and editable templates/components.
- Complete core page set.
- Reusable program page structure.
- Contact/application forms.
- SEO fundamentals.
- Analytics/search integration.
- Performance optimisation.
- Security and backup configuration.
- Mobile/tablet optimisation.
- Testing and launch support.
- Admin/content handover.
- Documentation of plugins, licences, services and recurring costs.

23. Design Approval Principle

The developer/designer is free to propose a better visual or technical solution than the examples implied in this document. Any alternative should preserve the underlying Pranava requirements: institutional credibility, Gurukula-inspired character, educational clarity, restrained design, strong visitor journeys, maintainability and future scalability.

The chosen theme, template or technology is an implementation decision—not the definition of the Pranava brand.

Appendix A — One-Page Creative Brief

Pranava should feel like a contemporary Gurukula: rooted, thoughtful, warm, scholarly and alive. The site should use generous space, natural colours, authentic photography and elegant typography. It should present Yoga as a field of study and practice rather than as a fitness product. Visitors should be able to enter through four clear doors—Learn, Practice, Heal and Insights—and find a credible path forward.

Visual shorthand: handmade paper • forest green • sandstone • antique brass • editorial serif headings • clean sans-serif UI • natural photography • quiet Indian cultural references • minimal decoration • no visual clutter.

Appendix B — Working Ownership

Client / Institution: Pranava – Center for Indian Culture & Yogic Studies

Implementation collaborator: To be appointed

Document status: Working Draft — Version 1.0

Update this document as decisions are made. Record changes that affect information architecture, ownership, recurring costs, platform lock-in or long-term maintainability.